VitaFit: Connect & Commit

PRD · Gamification & Rewards + Community Challenges · v2 · P = planning figure, replaced by VitaFit's Week-1 actuals

DESCRIPTION

Two features that attack one retention problem. **Gamification & Rewards** gives visible progress for consistent workouts and turns instructor discovery into a relationship. **Community Challenges** turns solo workouts into instructor-led shared goals. Loop: workout → progress → instructor note → challenge → return.

PROBLEM

On-demand users lose motivation after the first weeks, train alone, and have **no reason to prefer one instructor over another**. Nothing today brings them back on a day they do not feel like it.

WHY WE BELIEVE IT

- **External signal (public research):** in a 2009 IHRSA / HCD / Les Mills survey of 2,200+ US and Canadian club members, group-class participants attended twice as often as other members [2]. Typical health and fitness apps keep only 3–8% of users at day 30 [1]. Sources on page 6.
- **Internal signals, confirmed in Week 1** before build: early-session drop-off, workouts per active user, % repeating with the same instructor in 30 days, and cancel reasons. No challenges exist today.
- **Stop rule:** if baseline 3+ workouts/week is already ≥40% of active users, there is too little headroom; if >40% of cancellations cite content quality or price, this PRD targets the wrong majority. Pause either way.
- **What this will not fix:** churn from content quality, price or injury. Those users get nothing from points or challenges.

SUCCESS

North Star: % of active users completing 3+ workouts in a week. Measured as beta variant vs control, same segment, same weeks.

Metric	Baseline	Beta target (Wk 6)	Go bar vs control (Wk 10)
North Star: 3+ workouts/week	25% P	32%	≥ +4 pts
Sessions / active user / week	2.0 P	2.5	≥ +0.3
7-day repeat workout rate	45% P	55%	≥ +5 pts
Repeat with same instructor (30 days)	20% P	30%	≥ +5 pts
Challenge: joined ≥1 / completed (of joiners)	none exist	30% / 50%	completion ≥ 40%
30-day retention (read at Wk 10)	40% P	(not a Wk 6 output)	≥ +4 pts

Guardrails: (1) **Instructor recognition completion rate** = notes sent ÷ notes due that week, must stay ≥70%. (2) Instructor time ≤20 min/week each. (3) Users who never join a challenge: sessions/week not down >2% vs control. (4) Push opt-outs up ≤1 pt.

Decision rule, Week 10. GO to Phase 2 only if North Star ≥ +4 pts, 30-day retention ≥ +4 pts and guardrail 1 ≥70%. **Kill the recognition feature** if completion is <50% for two weeks running (fall back to tone-pick notes only). **Stop all of it** if North Star lift is <+2 pts. Cohort ≥2,000 users per arm P, confirmed by a power check in Week 1.

AUDIENCE

Primary (beta): working professionals 25–35 with a standing at-home routine who default to Yoga, HIIT or Zumba on demand and train alone. Their habit exists; motivation dips interrupt it, so they show a retention lift fastest. **Secondary (Phase 2):** Gen Z 18–24, whose drivers (social proof, novelty) need their own read.

WHAT: FEATURE 1, GAMIFICATION & REWARDS

VitaPoints (all rates are starting values P)

Action	Pts
Finish a workout (≥70% of class watched; max 2 count per day)	10
Hit weekly goal (3 workouts)	+20
7-day streak	+25
First class with a new instructor (max 3/month)	+15
Complete a challenge	+100

Badges: Bronze 100, Silver 400, Gold 1,000 pts. A 3-workout-a-week user earns ~50 pts/week: Bronze in ~2 weeks, Silver in ~8, Gold in ~20.

Rewards: badges, plus 300 pts unlocks a bonus class from a followed instructor. Content already exists, so no cash cost.

Streak rules and the broken state

- A streak day = ≥1 qualifying workout. One **rest-day pass** per 7 days is used automatically.
- **Broken:** streak resets, **best streak is kept**. Home says "Streak paused at 12 days. Best: 12." Restart within 48h earns +10 comeback points.
- One reminder push per day at the user's usual workout time, no shaming copy.

Instructor recognition: the differentiator (full flow on page 4)

- **Milestones:** first class with an instructor, 7-day streak while following, 8 sessions with one instructor, challenge completion.
- **Eligible if** the user follows the instructor, got no note from them in 14 days, and has <1 note this week across instructors.
- **Weekly batch:** opens Monday 9am, closes Sunday 8pm, max 25 members per instructor, ordered 8 sessions > challenge > 7-day > first class. Instructor records 10–15s video/audio **or** picks 1 of 3 tones (Cheer, Calm, Challenge) and edits one line. Budget ≤20 min/week, tested with 5 instructors in Week 3.
- **Failure:** unsent items roll over once, then expire at day 14 and the user gets the badge only. **We never tell a user a note is pending.** Unfollow cancels the item. Failed upload keeps a draft.
- **Member side:** push, then a Home card. One-tap reaction back; instructor sees the reaction count. No free-text replies in V1.

WHAT: FEATURE 2, COMMUNITY CHALLENGES

- 7-day instructor-led challenges (Yoga, Zumba, HIIT); join solo or with up to 5 friends. **Complete = 5 of 7 days**, so one missed day does not end it. Reward: +100 pts, badge, instructor note.
- **Cold start:** the community board and leaderboard open only at ≥20 joiners. Below that, the join window extends 3 days once, then the challenge runs **solo**: own progress plus the instructor's pace, board hidden. Leaderboard shows top 10 and you, with opt-out.
- **Partial:** 4 of 7 earns +20 pts and a "rejoin next week" card. Two missed days in a row sends one nudge in the instructor's voice.

HOW: EXPERIMENT

A/B on the primary segment only: current VitaFit (control) vs both features (variant). Beta runs one challenge each for Yoga, Zumba and HIIT, seeded from pre-registered beta users. Hypotheses: **H1** visible progress raises return frequency (sessions/week). **H2** instructor notes raise same-instructor repeats more than discovery alone. **H3** challenge joiners complete more workouts than matched non-joiners. **H4** one weekly batch is enough without overloading instructors (guardrail 1).

CONSIDERED AND CUT

Free-text replies (moderation cost). Cash-value rewards (margin, and they crowd out intrinsic motivation). Per-session instructor shout-outs (does not scale). Gen Z test (different drivers, so Phase 2).

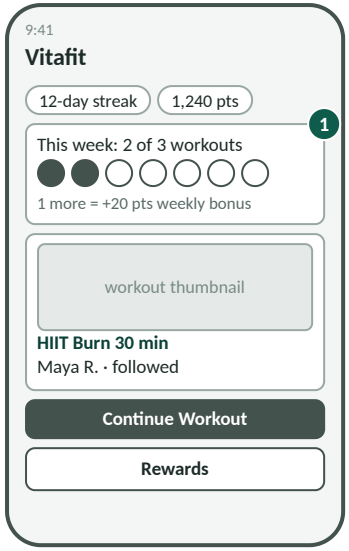
WHEN

Week	Milestone
1	Confirm baselines, cancel reasons, power check; lock rates
2	Flows and wireframes (pages 3–5)
3	Prototype + usability test, incl. 5 instructors on the batch
4	MVP build
5–6	Beta; read 7-day repeat, sessions/week, challenge join and completion, guardrails
10	30-day retention read; GO / KILL / STOP per page 1 rule

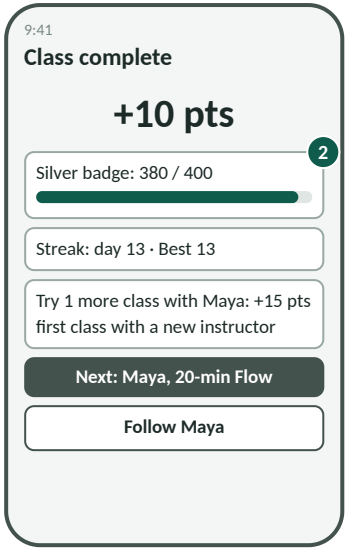
Phase 2 (if GO): group challenges, personalised challenges, richer rewards, Gen Z test.

Flow A · Gamification & Rewards

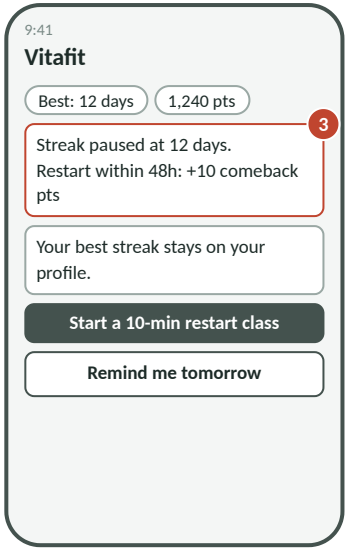
One workout, end to end, including the day a streak breaks. 1 engagement lift 3 retention trigger



A1 Home. Streak, points and weekly goal on the first screen.



A2 After class. Near-miss on the next badge pulls the next session.



A3 Broken streak. Best is kept; one tap to restart.

Where engagement rises

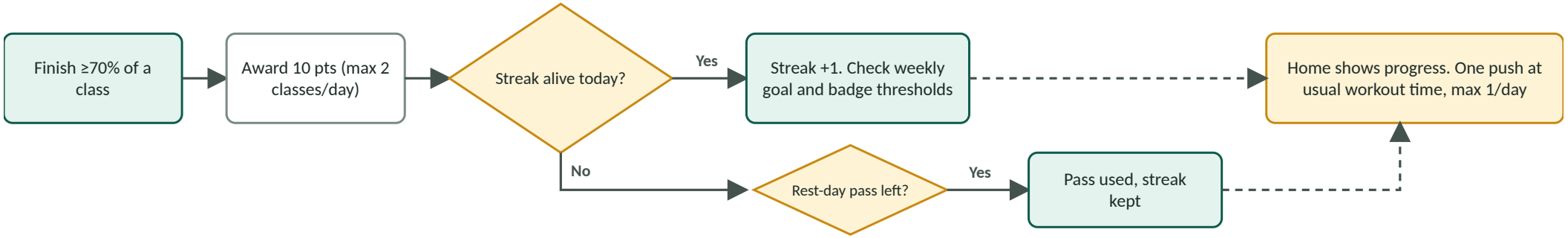
- A1: the weekly goal is one workout away, with a bonus attached.
- A2: "380 / 400" is the pull to take another class today.

Where retention triggers sit

- A3: a break never erases the best streak, so quitting costs less than restarting.
- Rest-day pass: one missed day does not zero a habit.
- 48h comeback bonus: the cheapest moment to win a user back.

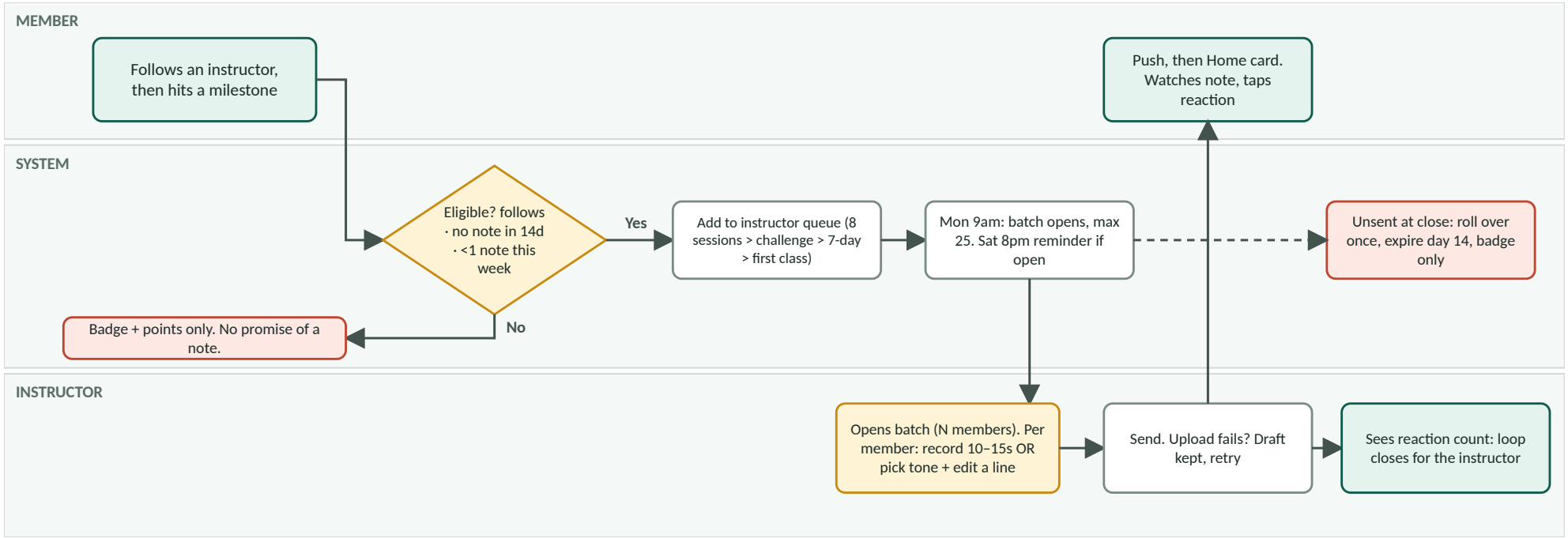
Not shown

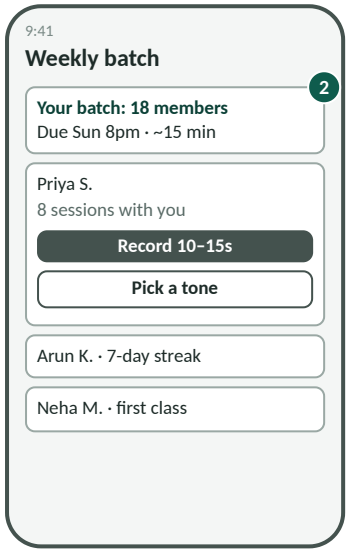
Rewards store and badge shelf: list screens with no new decisions.



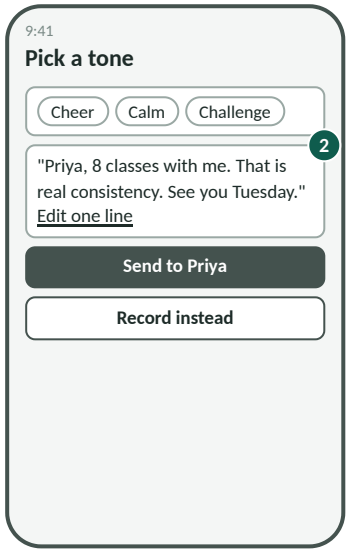
Flow B · Instructor recognition, member and instructor side

The differentiator, drawn end to end including what happens when it fails. Diamonds are decisions; red boxes are failure or fallback paths.

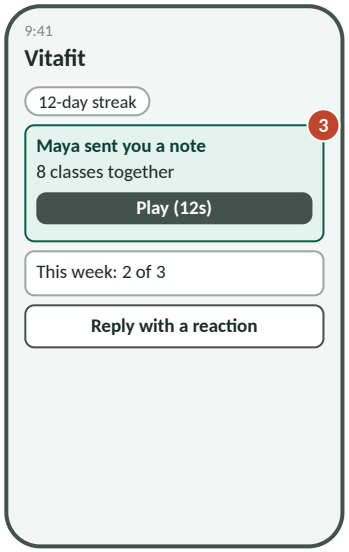




B1 Instructor dashboard. One batch a week, not per session.



B2 Tone option. Instructor is never writing from scratch.



B3 Member Home. Card stays until opened; replay in Profile.

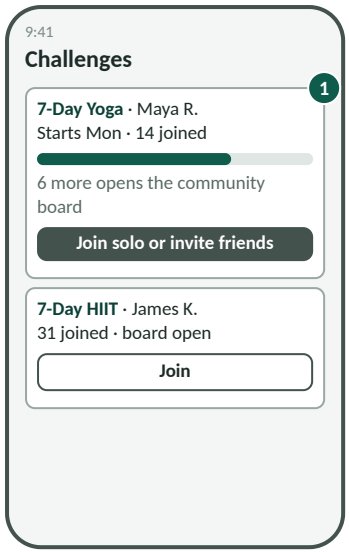
Why it is built this way

- One weekly batch caps instructor effort at ~20 min, so it can survive past the beta.
- Users are never told a note is pending, so a missed batch costs nothing visible.
- The reaction tap gives the instructor a reason to keep doing it.

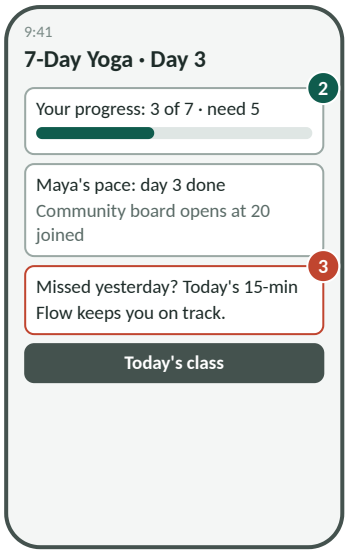
2 engagement 3 retention trigger

Flow C · Community Challenge, including the empty-board case

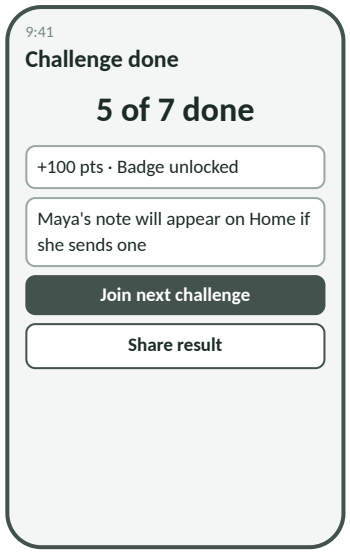
From list to completion. The path below the first diamond is the cold-start answer: a 4-person challenge still works, solo.



C1 Discover. Shows what is needed to unlock the board.



C2 In progress (solo mode). Instructor pace stands in for the board.



C3 Finish. No promise of a note. Next challenge is one tap.

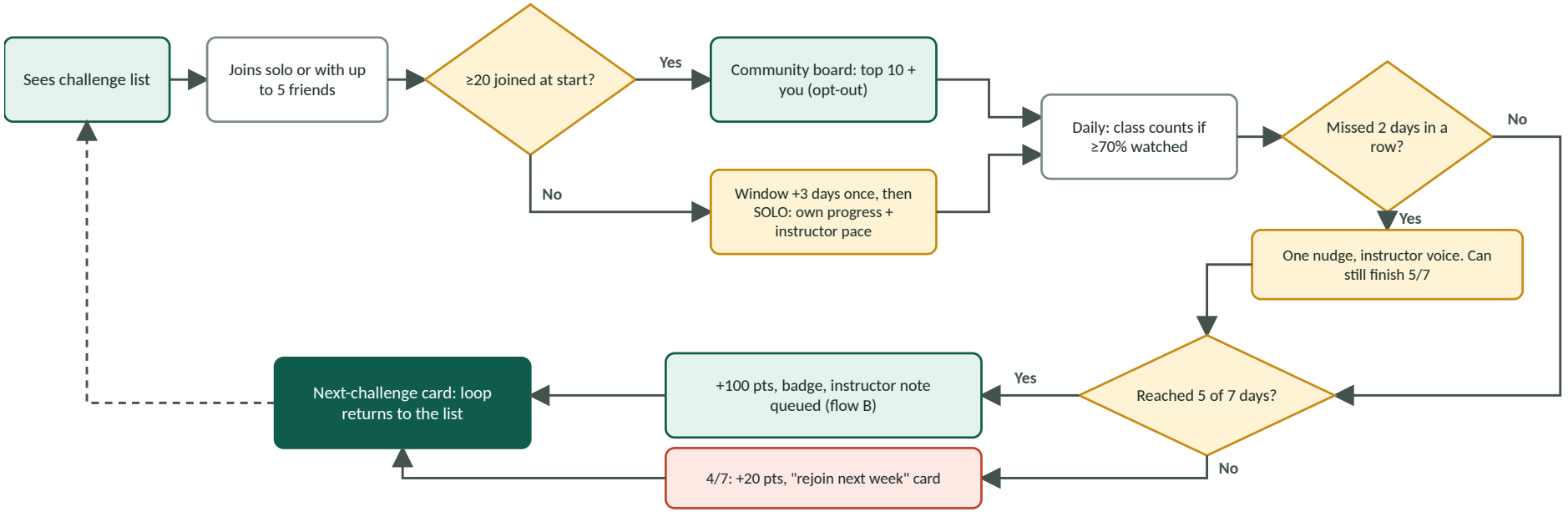
Where engagement rises

- C1: "6 more opens the board" gives a reason to invite friends.
- C2: "need 5" with a progress bar, not "7 of 7".

Where retention triggers sit

- C2: a missed day gets a recovery class, not a failure message.
- C3: next challenge is one tap, so the finish line is a hand-off, not an exit.

1 engagement 3 retention trigger



Evidence and sources

Public research and public product observation behind the PRD. P figures in the PRD are planning figures until VitaFit's Week-1 data replaces them.

#	Source (date)	What it says	How the PRD uses it
[1]	**Business of Apps**, Health & Fitness App Benchmarks, citing Adjust and AppsFlyer, 2023 businessofapps.com/data/health-fitness-app-benchmarks	Day-1 retention 27% (Adjust). Day-30 retention 3% (AppsFlyer) to 8% (Adjust). Over half of weekly and monthly subscribers churn by the third renewal.	Confirms the retention problem is typical. These are all-install figures, not VitaFit's paying cohort, so they are context, not a baseline.
[2]	**Australasian Leisure Management**, 29 Jul 2009, reporting IHRSA, HealthClub Development Co. and Les Mills, n > 2,200 club members, Feb–Mar 2009 ausleisure.com.au/news/group-fitness-classes-increase-club-attendance-retention	Les Mills class participants attend their clubs twice as often as other members. 72.2% intend to renew. No renewal figure is given for other members.	Supports the "structured, shared sessions raise repeat use" belief. It is gym attendance and is 17 years old, so it is a direction, not a forecast.
[3]	**Taplytics blog**, Peloton app review (undated; vendor blog) taplytics.com/blog/peloton-app-retention	Live instructors can call out members' achievements. Challenges and badges have bronze, silver and gold tiers. Members join tags and see what their tag is taking.	Reference model for the Bronze / Silver / Gold badges and the instructor recognition moment. A public observation of the product, not Peloton data.

Still to be confirmed with VitaFit data in Week 1: baseline 3+ workouts a week, sessions per active user, 7-day repeat, same-instructor repeat, 30-day retention, cancel reasons, and the share of cancellations citing content quality or price.